

CAST

AMALTHEA (SHE/HER)

Human barmaid, cook, and owner of the Voyager Inn. Red-haired, beautiful, ditzy, and lucky. She is nursing her 4-month-old baby, so the player has been filling in more of her barkeeping duties around the tavern lately.

CONELLIO (HE/HIM)

Amalthea's husband. He does as much of the service around the inn as she, but isn't as much of a people person. Has a good eye for unscrupulous behavior and is very paranoid towards anything that could threaten the safety of the inn.

PALISPATE (HE/HIM)

The party wizard. The only one with fire spells, he uses them frequently. He appears to be the party's leader, but this is only because he manages the party's treasure and tools inside his magic satchel.

IONA (SHE/HER)

The party cleric. A dwarf priestess of the harvest god Hilmata. She is the secondary fighter and uses a big hammer in combat. Very trustworthy, her overly honest nature means nobody in the party tells her their secrets.

GILLIAN (THEY/THEM)

The party bard. A fae changeling who wears a featureless mask. Cheerful and full of mirth, yet even with such a charming personality, nobody can fully trust a faceless shapeshifter.

Amalthea



VALEULDO (DAE/DIEM)

The party sorcerer. A tall dark elf who practices necromancy. Diem foul aura make diem naturally suspicious, especially whenever bodies go missing.

CARMIE (THEY/HER)

The party rogue. A young half-devil with bad manners and fast fingers. Even when they are on their best behavior, who would ever trust a professional criminal?

JOVIAN (HE/HIM)

The party fighter. A huge half-orc with a massive greatsword. Kind and chummy at first blush, the rest of the party knows he becomes a rageful monster in the heat of battle.

KENT (HE/HIM)

The party ranger and guide. He nurtures a drinking problem, as well as other addictive tendencies. Not sociable in the slightest, he is a man of little patience and few words.

ALKIN (HE/THEY)

A nearby woodcutter and druid. He can take the form of a dire bear to defend the nearby townspeople and their woods. Visits the inn to warn Conellio of bad weather or bandits.

INTRO

The player is a bartender at the Voyager Inn, living in the nearby town of Jurpo within the frigid Thebe Valley. They begin the day working with the regular customers when Conellio comes in with a load of firewood. He says that Alkin told him to prepare for a



rough storm the next few days. As he says this, it begins to snow, growing heavier and fiercer throughout the day.

With the regular customers leaving for their homes in the village, the adventuring party of Palisphate, Iona, Gillian, Valeuldo, Carmie, Jovian, and Kent arrive out of the cold. Palisphate offers a sizable sack of gold for full room and board while they wait out the storm.

At this point, the weather outside is a complete whiteout with howling winds, making travel back to town a dangerous undertaking. Amalthea suggests the player stay in one of the inn's rooms, leaving five other upstairs rooms for the seven adventurers to divide among themselves.

Palisphate uses his fire magic to enchant the fireplace and warm the whole inn, while the other party members order drinks or try to keep themselves busy while waiting for nightfall.

THE CHANGE

Before nightfall, the player is asked to go check on the party's horses in the inn's adjoining stables. When they do so, they are attacked from behind by a mysterious assailant and wake up hours later when Gillian finds them unconscious. There is a dark veiny wound on the player's back that heals quickly. Multiple horses are missing, and the party believes this attack was the work of local gnolls (hyena beastfolk).

While this is true, the player was also infected by a scrap of a chaos beast attached to the underside of one of the horses. It burrowed into the player's wound while they were unconscious. It is a flesh warping monster that now lives inside the player and wants to grow by incorporating more bodies into its undulating mass. It also infected one of the gnolls and a missing horse.

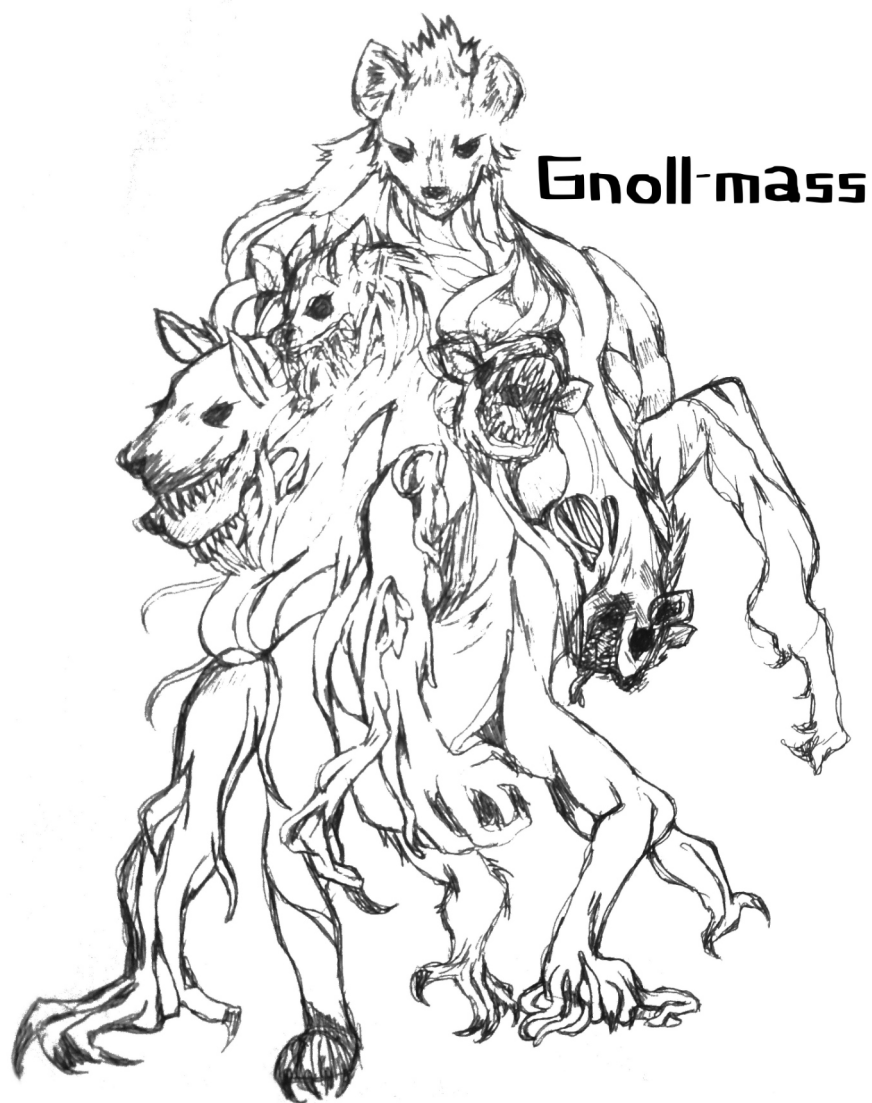
BUILDUP

After the attack, the party is on high alert and decides to have some of them take watch in shifts overnight in case the gnolls try to attack the inn again.

Kent goes to bed looking very sickly, vomiting profusely, and waking up with horrid hangover that confines him to bed. He suspects that someone poisoned his drink (the reality is he has chronic kidney failure from his alcoholic abuse).

On the morning of the second day, the winds have slowed but the snow is still building. The party cannot navigate the storm without Kent in better health, so they decide to spend another day at the inn to see if conditions improve.

Tensions begin to wear thin and party members start infighting. At a certain point, the gnolls attack the inn and half the party head outside to fight them. The gnolls have been transformed into a multi-limbed monstrous mass that will wound one of the party members. After, Alkin arrives and warns Conellio about an creature wandering in the snow (the missing horse).



At this point, the party pieces together that the chaos beast they fought on their last adventure has followed them here. This is confirmed when Jovian finds some of its still writhing remains stuck to the underside of his boot. From here, all hell breaks loose as accusations fly among the party members and player. They know that once it is matured inside a host, the chaos beast can take over anyone's body and mimic them.

Palisphate offers to use his fire spells to test people for infection with the chaos beast, as it has a painful reaction to open flame. However, he only has five spell slots per day and will always save the last one for self-defense.

CLIMAX

The inn's stores of dried meat run low on the third day, but Iona can use spells to conjure bread for sustenance. Conellio starts going mad on the third day, demanding that nobody leave the inn or his sight until he makes sure that everyone has been tested with Palisphate's fire. He even begins to suspect his own wife and child for acting oddly. The player must make their move to consume someone or escape.

If the player's physical changes are revealed, most of the party members and Conellio will immediately attack them or flee. If Iona is fighting the player, she will try to capture them non-lethally to exorcise the evil within them (this process is slowly fatal).

Valeuldo has no reaction to the player’s changes. Carmie will say nothing but attempts to blackmail the player. Gillian will think the player is awakening as a fellow changeling at first. Amalthea will assume the player is just very ill with some strange disease.

ENDINGS

If the player gets nine or more change points and has consumed one humanoid, Valeuldo approaches them (at a distance), curious as to what mixture of human and monster the player has evolved into. Dae offer the player an escape into the underground world of the dark elves, where the player can feed freely and grow even stronger (Permanence). Dae can also offer a spell to stop the changes, though this does not reverse them immediately.

Otherwise, the player either devours as many people as possible or is killed by the party. If they escape into the town to feast on the more vulnerable citizens, Alkin will confront the player in their dire bear form to protect the innocents.

TIPS & EXTRAS

The party pretends like they are all well acquainted and friendly, but after the first night, the cracks in their loyalty will start to show. They only recently teamed up after slaying a chaos beast in the underground caverns. Each party member wants the dragon’s treasure for themselves, but they each have one other person whom they watch closely.

Palisphate	Watches Valeuldo; dark elves live unfathomably long lives, so Palisphate respects his elders.
Iona	Watches Carmie; Iona swore to protect the youngest from evil influence, determined to exorcise Carmie’s devil side eventually.
Gillian	Watches Jovian; the half-orc’s face and body are Gillian’s preferred form, so they take care to study Jovian’s mannerisms.
Valeuldo	Watches Gillian; dae share an on-off sexual relationship and enjoy making Gillian wear the faces of diem’s former lovers while in bed.
Carmie	Watches Palisphate; the wizard’s fire magic fascinates her (and also he carries the coin purse...)
Jovian	Watches Iona; the only one who could best him in a fight.
Kent	Watches nobody and nobody would miss him if he disappeared.

physical
aptitude
mental

An extra eye, a second mouth, additional fingers. Appendages useful to food gathering multiply innocuously over your fluid skin membrane.

Protein tastes good. Your body has no need for less optimal nutrients. Living matter is even better. You viscerally reject the ingestion of substances that do not contribute to growth.

Your body adapts as necessary to secure prey items. You naturally warp your flesh into the form of weapons when around vulnerable organisms.

You see the world through thermal vision. Faces and expressions are impossible to discern, all other organic beings are meat sacks of warmth and viscera. Devour them.

Not only can you turn yourself into weapons, you can re-purpose organic matter into yourself as fresh limbs and organs. Your skin rips apart to fit all these new body parts.

Vocal capacity is unnecessary for food acquisition. You do not need to communicate, only impersonate. When you absorb a brain, you can also sift through its memories and mimic their actions.

permanence

Nothing has changed. You used to be something... else? No, that's wrong. You were always this creature of hunger. Each day you do not consume your weight in meat, take 4 points of damage.

no going back

You are not human. All organic matter exists for your consumption, means to further your growth. You do not see other living things as living. They exist only as meat parts yet separate from you.

Mortal wounds are scratches, your regenerative powers are too advanced to fear death. Only fire can truly damage you. Restore all points of Physical attribute damage.

Human speech is largely unnecessary. Their words are like the buzzing of flies, useless white noise. You do not waste valuable mental space by processing its meaning.

Your body resists damage by any means necessary. When threatened with injury, your flesh twists into whatever shape will best protect you.

Instinct overcome your morals and emotions. Acts which were formally unspeakable to you are now necessities. Nothing takes priority above your survival and growth.

mental
fortitude
physical

A human form is just a useful skin disguise. Under the thin layer of epidermis, your internal structure is constantly rearranging.